Rainbow – the chakra system

In the usual order of seven colours blue stands between green and indigo. In the rainbow map of the chakras it is the fifth and belongs to the throat chakra. **You can** imagine it as a place for **your own voice**, honest expression and listening.

The whole rainbow as a map of questions

Red · root



Safety, support, presence. Ask yourself. Do I have something to lean on? What gives me a sense of safety right now?

Yellow · solar plexus



Self-worth, will. Ask yourself. What do I want? Where do I need to stand up for myself?

Blue · throat



Voice, expression, listening. Ask yourself. What do I need to say? What do I no longer want to keep swallowing?

Violet · crown



Meaning, transcendence, connection. Ask yourself. What gives me meaning? What do I feel connected to?

Orange · sacral



Experiencing, pleasure, creating. Ask yourself. What does me good? Where do I allow myself joy?

Green · heart



Closeness, relationships. Ask yourself. How am I with myself? Whom do I let close?

Indigo · third eye



Inner vision, intuition. Ask yourself. What is beginning to dawn on me?

Chakra. Vishuddha, the throat chakra

The chakras come from the Indian yogic and tantric tradition. The throat chakra is called Vishuddha (from Sanskrit “purified” or “pure”). It sits in the throat area and the element ether (space), the seed syllable HAM and a lotus with sixteen petals belong to it. Blue is linked with it mainly in today's version. In some traditional descriptions other shades are given too, for example a smoky violet.

Its theme is communication, expression and truthfulness. For women this often turns into questions. Shall I say what I feel, or keep it to myself? Does anyone hear me, and do I hear myself?

When it is open. You say what you need and you can also listen. Your voice supports you, **you do not have to** apologise for speaking. You can also be silent when it is appropriate.

When it is closed. The tradition describes difficulty expressing yourself, **fear** of other people's reaction, a held-back word or, on the contrary, talking without end and without real contact. Closed does not mean bad. It is only a signal that the words in you lack a way out.

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How to add blue when you lack your own voice

A colour will not give you your voice back, but it can be a small reminder and invitation. Here are the forms in which **you can** let it into your life.

- **Wear it**
  A blue scarf, shawl or necklace near the throat. The throat is in the tradition the place of the voice and the colour will remind you of it.
- **Put it in your home**
  A blue mug, cushion or picture of the sea or sky in a place you look at every day.
- **Take it with you**
  A blue pebble, hair tie or ribbon in your pocket. Something you can touch when words will not come.
- **Take the sky and water**
  A few minutes by a window with a view of the sky, a walk by a river, a blue glass on the table.
- **Paint it**
  Wide blue stripes or circles at the top of the paper, with no goal and no judging.
- **Say it aloud**
  A blue mug in your hand and one sentence you have not said for a long time. Even just to a mirror or in your phone notes.

How to supplement blue when you talk too much

When words flow but nobody is really listening to you (and neither are you), you do not need more blue, but something that will **calm** and ground you.

- **Add green**
  Calm from trees and nature. Green in the flat or a walk in the forest helps you slow down and listen.
- **Add brown**
  Support and stability. Wood, natural materials, a feeling of earth under your feet.
- **Take away rich blue**
  Swap dark, cold shades for lighter and warmer ones until you feel warmer again.
- **Add orange**
  A warm counterpart and a spark. Terracotta, amber, a candle.

Ask yourself

"What would I need to say aloud today?"

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When it is said “closed”. What to imagine by it

Perhaps you repeatedly say “I do not mind” even though you have your own wish. Before an important sentence you withdraw, rather agree or first defend everything at length. In the language of the chakras such an experience can be described as blocked expression. By itself, however, it proves neither the state of a chakra nor an illness.

Blue on the body. Take a piece of jewellery, a shirt or underwear in a shade in which you feel good. Give it the meaning “my wishes have a place too”. In a concrete situation a single sentence may then be enough: “Today I would rather stay at home.” **You do not have to** force yourself into a big conversation.

When you talk over yourself and over others

In some readings the image of an “overactive” chakra is used. Interrupting, defending every little thing or **fear** of silence. Take it as a chance to notice a habit, not as a label. A blue bracelet can recall the space between sentences. Once you notice it, let the other person finish the thought. Then answer. The aim is not to talk less at any price, but to give room to yourself and to the other.

When the words are not there yet

A blue notebook can be a private place without an audience. Write what you would say if you did not have to defend yourself. **You do not have to** send it to anyone. If you do not want to write, **you can** stay with an image, a colour or silence. Not everything needs to be said immediately. If it feels pleasant to hum quietly, **try** an ordinary sound without performing and without controlling the breath. If it is uncomfortable, stop. It is not a test of the right vibration or a method of treating the throat.

Why blue, and which shade?

In this contemporary map blue is a symbol of expression and room for the voice. We draw the meaning from the tradition; the pigment itself has no proven ability to unblock a chakra. A soft sky blue may seem welcoming to you, a rich blue decisive and a dark one intimate. Take them as possibilities for your own experience. If a scarf round your neck feels tight or the colour is **unpleasant** to you, **you do not have to** have it at your throat. The same personal meaning can be carried by a ring or a private detail of underwear.

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How to tell that this work gives you something

In everyday life **you may** notice that you can voice a small wish without apologising, more easily let someone finish speaking or allow yourself to be silent. There is no need to check whether the chakra is already “open”. What matters is your experience, not meeting a spiritual doctrine.

Throat and health. Hoarseness, **pain** or difficulty swallowing should not be judged by a chakra. Persistent problems belong with a doctor. The examples with blue are prompts for self-knowledge and expression, not treatment.

Picture it with an example

You have on the tip of your tongue a sentence you have been putting off for a week. Green may ask how you are with yourself while doing it. Yellow, what you want. And blue. Shall I say it aloud? Blue does not stand here as a verdict, more as a calm question that **you can** answer at your own pace.

Next to blue other colours can feel calmer. Yellow makes it glow, white widens it and orange warms it. **These are possibilities of a personal reading**, not effects prescribed by a combination of colours.

How to use this map

It is a way of sorting out the themes you are living through. Do you add blue because you miss words and calm to say what you need? Or do you take it away because it is already cold around you? **You choose the meaning.** An added colour does not diagnose your state.

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